

Class 10th | English



Footprints Without Feet

FOOTPRINTS WITHOUT FEET

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. Why did Mrs. Hall find the scientist (the new guest) eccentric?

Ans. Mrs. Hall found the scientist eccentric because of his strange behaviour. When she tried to be friendly with him, he rejected her by telling her that he had come there for peace and did not want to be disturbed in his work.

QUESTIONS

2. Describe the curious episode which took place in a clergyman's study.

Ans. The curious episode occurred in the study of the clergyman's house. One very early morning, the clergyman and his wife heard noises coming from their study. They heard the sound of money being taken.
However, when they entered the study, nobody could be found but the money was stolen.

QUESTIONS

3. What other extraordinary things happen at the inn?

Ans. Many extraordinary things happened at the inn with Mrs. Hall and her husband. One day, early in the morning, they found the scientist's door to be open and went inside, while there was nobody in the room.

Suddenly, Mrs. Hall heard a sniff. Soon, a hat kept on the bedpost was thrown on her face. Then, a chair was thrown at her legs and it pushed both Mrs. Hall and his husband out of the room. This made Mrs. Hall think that the furniture was haunted.

QUESTIONS

4. "Griffin was rather a lawless person." Comment.

Ans. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but he was a lawless person. After becoming invisible because of his experiment, he not only set his landlord's house on fire but also robbed a theatrical shop in London. Later in Iping, he robbed the clergyman and also hit the villagers including Mrs. Hall, her husband and constable Jaffers.

QUESTIONS

5. How would you assess Griffin as a scientist?

Ans. Griffin was a brilliant scientist. His great capabilities come forward when he continuously conducts experiments to prove that the human body can become invisible. After a lot of efforts, he proves so by making himself invisible. However, his greatness is reduced because of his lawless actions. This discovery could have been used to benefit the society but is used only by him for his own benefit.

QUESTIONS

- 6.** Identify the option that aptly describes Griffin.
- (a)** Greedy, yet kind
 - (b)** Proud and honourable
 - (c)** Considerate and selfless
 - (d)** Brilliant, but lawless

QUESTIONS

Ans. (d) Brilliant, but lawless

QUESTIONS

- 7.** Griffin became a homeless wanderer because he
- (a)** was an eccentric scientist
 - (b)** was very greedy
 - (c)** had to go without clothes
 - (d)** had set fire to his landlord's house

QUESTIONS

Ans. (d) had set fire to his landlord's house

QUESTIONS

- 8.** Why was it a bad time for Griffin to wander about in London?
- (a)** It was mid-winter
 - (b)** He wanted to be alone
 - (c)** He did not have clothes
 - (d)** Both (a) and (e)

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) It was mid-winter

QUESTIONS

- 9.** Read the given statements and choose the correct answer.
- (A) Griffin stole clothes from the store.
 (B) Griffin was a revengeful man.
- (a)** (A) is right (B) is wrong
(b) (A) is wrong (B) is right
(c) Both are right
(d) Both are wrong

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) Both are right

QUESTIONS

- 10.** Which option best describes Mrs. Hall from 'Footprints Without Feet'?
- (a)** Hospitable but firm
 - (b)** Scared and superstitious
 - (c)** Accommodating but curious
 - (d)** Opportunistic and insensitive

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) Hospitable but firm

QUESTIONS

11. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

He escaped easily enough from the boys who followed his footprints in London. But his adventures were by no means over. He had chosen a bad time of the year to wander about London without clothes.

It was mid-winter. The air was bitterly cold and he could not do without clothes. Instead of walking about the streets, he decided to slip into a big London store for warmth.

QUESTIONS

i. State True or False.

None of the terms (a)-(d) can be applied to the statement - It was mid-winter.

- (a) A fact - a thing that is known or proved to be true
- (b) An assumption - something that is taken for granted or assumed to be true
- (c) A hyperbole - exaggerated statements or claims not meant to be taken literally
- (d) A premise - a proposition that forms the basis of an argument



QUESTIONS

Ans. False; A fact

QUESTIONS

ii. State the reason why could escape from the boys.

Ans. He could escape from the boys because he went along a street where there was no mud.

QUESTIONS

iii. Mention what happened that day after the invisible man slipped into a big London store.

Ans. After the invisible man slipped into a big London store for warmth, he waited for the closing time.

As soon as the door was shut, he clothed and fed himself without thinking of expense. He then went to sleep on a pile of quilts.

QUESTIONS

iv. The phrase 'slip into means the same as

Ans. enter quietly

QUESTIONS

12. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

The arrival of a stranger at an inn in winter was in any case an unusual event. A stranger of such uncommon appearance set all tongues wagging. Mrs. Hall, the landlord's wife, made every effort to be friendly. But Griffin had no desire to talk and told her, "My reason for coming to Iping is a desire for solitude. I do not wish to be disturbed in my work. Besides, an accident has affected my face."

Satisfied that her guest was an eccentric scientist and in view of the fact that he had paid her in advance, Mrs. Hall was prepared to excuse his strange habits and irritable temper. But the stolen money did not last long and presently Griffin had to admit that he had no more ready cash. He pretended, however, that he was expecting a cheque to arrive at any moment.

QUESTIONS

- i.** In which of these does 'ready' have the same meaning as used in the extract?
- (a)** Griffin didn't believe that he was ready to speak before the audience
 - (b)** The landlord usually got the rooms ready before any guests arrived
 - (c)** Mrs. Hall said there was a ready supply of food at the hotel
 - (d)** The stranger was getting ready to take on new challenges

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) Mrs. Hall said there was a ready supply of food at the hotel

QUESTIONS

ii. Complete the analogy by selecting a suitable word from the text.

Arrival : Exit :: _____ : Company

Ans. Solitude

QUESTIONS

iii. State True or False.

None of the given statements is false for the inn.

- (a)** Its location was remote.
- (b)** Its customers were mainly locals.
- (c)** It was a popular tourist destination.
- (d)** It required rent to be paid in advance.

QUESTIONS

Ans. False. Statements (a) and (b) are true for the inn.

QUESTIONS

iv. Mrs. Hall was prepared to ignore Griffin's rudeness and weird behaviour. State two reasons why this was so.

Ans. Mrs. Hall was prepared to ignore Griffin's rudeness and weird behaviour because she had accepted that Griffin was a strange scientist. Moreover, Griffin has already paid his rent in advance. So, Mrs. Hall had no problem with her new guest.

QUESTIONS

13. What made the boys follow Griffin?

Ans. The two boys in London were surprised and fascinated by the fresh muddy footprints they saw at the steps of a house. When they followed the footprints (Griffin), they were shocked to see that footprints were appearing but there was no man around the place.

QUESTIONS

14. Why did Griffin decide to slip into a big London store?

Ans. Griffin decided to slip into a big London store to get warm. It was mid-winter season and the weather was chilly. Hence, it became difficult for him to wander around without clothes in London.

QUESTIONS

15. How did Griffin find himself invisible but naked in the chill January air for the second time?

Ans. Griffin finds himself invisible but naked in the chill January air for the second time when two attendants of the London store discovered him hiding in their store and tried to chase him. Hence, in order to protect himself, he threw away all his clothes and became invisible again.

QUESTIONS

16. What did Griffin do in the shop of a theatrical company?

Ans. In the shop of a theatrical company, the invisible Griffin dressed himself to become visible. He wore bandages, sunglasses, whiskers and a fake nose. Further to avoid being seen, he attacked the shopkeeper and robbed all the money that he could find.

QUESTIONS

17. What happened when Mr. and Mrs. Hall entered the stranger's room?

Ans. When Mr. and Mrs. Hall entered the stranger's room, they found that the bed was cold and all his bandages were lying around. Suddenly, Mrs. Hall heard a sniff and the hat on the bedpost was thrown into her face. Then the bedroom chair was thrown at them and the Halls were pushed outside the room. As a result, Mr. and Mrs. Hall were very scared.

QUESTIONS

18. The neighbours suspected Griffin of burglary. State why this was or was not justified.

Ans. The neighbours suspected Griffin of burglary because he had produced some ready cash the next day after surgery after having accepted that he did not have any money with him. Their suspicion was justified.

QUESTIONS

19. Scientists contribute to make the world a better place. Griffin is an antithesis to this statement. Justify.

Ans. Griffin was a brilliant scientist but he was an antithesis to the fact that scientists contribute to make the world a better place. This is so because he uses his mind for making a good drug which could make anyone invisible but he used the drug unethically and immorally. He looted stores and showed violent behaviour after being invisible which takes away his credibility (honour and respect).

QUESTIONS

20. Do you find the story based on being invisible a mere figment of one's imagination or a phenomenon that is plausible? Elaborate with your opinion.

Ans. I find the story based on being invisible to be a story based on a mere figment of one's imagination. I think that the possibility of that being a reality would be very miniscule, even though I do not think that it is impossible.

QUESTIONS

21. Describe the landlord's and his wife's experience with the strange scientist.

Ans. The landlord and his wife had a very strange experience with the eccentric scientist. Once in an early morning, both of them were shocked to find the door of the scientist's room to be open. They knew that their guest did not like being disturbed and would normally keep the room locked. So, they looked inside only to find that nobody was present in the room. As they entered the room to investigate it, they found that the bed was cold and the clothes and bandages that their guest regularly wore were lying about in the room. Suddenly, Mrs. Hall heard a sniff and soon the hat on the bedpost was thrown at her face. Then, the chair was thrown at her legs and it pushed Mrs. Hall and her husband out of the room. The door was automatically shut and was locked. These shocking turn of events made Mrs. Hall hysterical. She almost fell down the stairs. She thought that her furniture was haunted and that the strange scientist was to be blamed for it.

QUESTIONS

22. How did Griffin's invisibility come to his help whenever he found himself in trouble?

Ans. Griffin was once a brilliant scientist who had worked hard to discover a drug (medicine) that could make a human body invisible and transparent. However, instead of using it for the welfare of the society, Griffin used his experiment to help him to commit petty crimes, thefts and burglaries. He became a lawless person hitting, beating and robbing innocent people. His invisibility only came to help whenever he caught himself in trouble or was in the danger of being caught and arrested.

The first time when his invisibility helped Griffin was when he laid asleep fully dressed on a pile of quilts in the big London store. When the employees of the store saw him, he panicked and ran away. When he was chased, he threw away all his clothes and save himself as he had become completely invisible.

QUESTIONS

Griffin's invisibility helped him rob not only a theater costume shop but also a clergyman in village Iping. Finally, when the village constable Jaffers came to arrest him, Griffin again became invisible. He, then, not only made the constable unconscious but also hit all those people who came to his help.

QUESTIONS

23. If somehow you discovered how to become invisible, how would you use that opportunity?

Ans. If I discovered how to become invisible, I would use the opportunity to punish all those people who cause trouble to others for their own selfish motives. I would catch them and hand them over to the police without letting them know that I was behind them. I will also help the law-enforcing agencies when they conduct raids on criminal hideouts, as I will be able to move in the open without fear of being seen. This will help the people of the country to become more law-abiding citizens.

We all should also realise this that if we are bestowed with a power, we have to follow some duties and fulfill some responsibilities towards our society, our nation and the world. We all have to use those powers in other's welfare.

A misuse of power can make us devil, while its proper and good use will definitely make us an angel or superhero in other's eyes. So, it is up to us to choose the right path.

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